# Jinho Kim

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Citizenship: South Korea | Website | LinkedIn

## Education

**Department of Economics, University of California, Davis** — Davis, CA, USA
*Ph.D. in Economics* — 2021–2026
- Fields: Macroeconomics, Household Finance, Real Estate

**Department of Economics, Yonsei University** — Seoul, South Korea
*B.A. in Economics* — 2005–2013

## Working Papers

1. **Who Captures the Rate Cut? Endogenous Attention and the Refinancing Channel of Monetary Policy**. 2026. *Job Market Paper*. [Paper]

   *Abstract:* I document that lower-income households are far less likely to capture the gains from refinancing when interest rates fall, and I quantify how this gap affects the transmission of monetary policy. When refinancing is financially advantageous, bottom-income-quintile borrowers refinance 43 percent less often than the top quintile. They also take longer to act and respond less to monetary policy shocks, even though refinancing would lower their payments the most relative to income. I explain this gradient with a heterogeneous-agent model in which households choose how closely to monitor their mortgage. Differences in refinancing gains account for about one third of the income gradient, and the rest requires a price of attention that falls with income. A notification policy calibrated to field-experimental evidence raises the five-year consumption response to a rate cut by 12.3 percent, even after households reduce their own monitoring, with the largest proportional gains at the bottom of the income distribution.

2. **Demographics and Housing Booms** (with Yungu Cho, Hyunseo Park, Jaeyoung Yoo). 2026. [Paper]

## Work in Progress

1. **Fixed-Rate Mortgages and the Cash-Flow Channel: Evidence from Rate Resets in Korea**. 2026.
2. **Local Projections Meet Big Data: Forecasting Nonlinear Economic Dynamics** (with James Cloyne, Òscar Jordà). 2026.
3. **Who Refinances, Who Spends? Refinancing Responsiveness and MPCs** (with Yungu Cho and Heejin Yoon). 2026.
4. **Mortgage Debt and the Consumption Response to Monetary Policy and Housing Wealth.** 2024.

## Awards & Honors

**Dean's Summer Support** ($3,930), *UC Davis* — Aug. 2025
**Department Research Award** ($8,522), *UC Davis* — Dec. 2024
**Department Travel Award** ($5,000 in total), *UC Davis* — Jun. 2024 – Dec. 2025
**Graduate Student Association Travel Grant** ($500), *UC Davis* — May 2024
**Doctoral Study Abroad Scholarship**, *Bank of Korea* — Jun. 2020
**Annual Thesis Competition** (3rd place), *Bank of Korea* — Jun. 2016
**Honors for Academic Excellence**, *Yonsei University* — Fall 2009, Fall 2005

## Presentations & Discussions

**Presentations**

WEAI Annual Conference, *Denver, USA* — Jun. 2026
AREUEA National Conference, *Washington, D.C., USA* — May 2026
American Finance Association Annual Meeting (poster), *Philadelphia, USA* — Jan. 2026
Southern Finance Association Annual Meeting, *Orlando, USA* — Nov. 2025
Financial Management Association Doctoral Consortium, *Vancouver, Canada* — Oct. 2025
World Congress of the Econometric Society, *Seoul, South Korea* — Aug. 2025
Journal of International Economics Summer School (poster), *University of Oxford* — Jul. 2024
Macro/International Lunchtime Presentation, *UC Davis* — May 2024; Mar. 2026

**Discussant**

"New Results on the Disparities between Same-Sex and Different-Sex Couples in the Home Mortgage Market," by Nir Eilam and Yeonjoon Lee
WEAI 101st Annual Conference, *Denver, USA* — Jun. 2026

"The Value of Mortgage Choice: Payment Structure and Contract Length," by Michael Boutros, Nuno Clara, and Katya Kartashova
Southern Finance Association Annual Meeting, *Orlando, USA* — Nov. 2025

## Teaching & Research Experience

**Research Assistant**

Professor James Cloyne, Project: "State-Dependent Local Projections: Understanding Impulse Response Heterogeneity" — 2024

**Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics, *UC Davis***

Macroeconomic Theory (Ph.D. Course) — 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026
Intermediate Macro, Principles of Macro/Micro, Money & Banking — 2021–2026

## Employment

**Bank of Korea** | Economist — 2014–2021; 2026–Present
**The Export-Import Bank of Korea** | Investment Officer — 2013
**Republic of Korea Air Force** | Sergeant — 2007–2009

## Policy Publications (Selected)

1. Euihwan Bae, **Jinho Kim**. Analysis of Stagnant Growth in the Service Industry of Daejeon. *Bank of Korea*, 2021.
2. **Jinho Kim**. Determinants of Chungnam Regional Export and Risk Factors. *Bank of Korea*, 2019.
3. Hyunman Kim, **Jinho Kim**. Labor Flexibility Effects on Employment and Productivity: Focusing on Classification of Flexibility. Award, *Bank of Korea Annual Thesis Competition*, 2016.
4. **Jinho Kim**, Yongbok Kim. Structural Changes in International Trade and Korea's Export. *Bank of Korea Economic Outlook*, 2015.
5. Youjung Cho, **Jinho Kim**, Yongbok Kim. The Impact on Korean Export of China's Policy to Restrain Processing Trade. *Bank of Korea Monthly Bulletin*, 2015.
6. **Jinho Kim**, Yongbok Kim. Analysis and Forecast of Korea's Export to China. *Bank of Korea Economic Outlook*, 2015.

## Other Information

**Languages:** Korean (native), English (fluent).
**Programming:** Python, Julia, MATLAB, Stata
**Citizenship:** South Korea

## References

**James Cloyne** (*Chair*)
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To request letters of recommendation by email, please contact the UC Davis Economics placement office at ucdecnjobmarket@ucdavis.edu. Staff will send the letters confidentially.

## Research Abstracts

**Working Papers**

1. **Demographics and Housing Booms** (with Yungu Cho, Hyunseo Park, Jaeyoung Yoo). 2026. [Paper]

   We show that the age structure of the population systematically shapes housing-boom vulnerability. Across OECD countries and U.S. counties, a one-unit increase in the young-to-old ratio raises the probability of a large housing boom by 18.6 and 4.3 percentage points, respectively. In mortgage application data, young applicants increase their application intensity 4.3 to 6.6 percent more than older applicants during local booms, and after an identified credit-supply easing, house prices rise more, and more persistently, in younger areas. We then show that a life-cycle housing model accounts for the larger initial price response in younger economies, because young households are concentrated at the margin between owning and renting and respond most to credit easing.

**Work in Progress**

1. **Fixed-Rate Mortgages and the Cash-Flow Channel: Evidence from Rate Resets in Korea.** 2026.

   In Korea, hybrid mortgages reset automatically after five years, on a date fixed at origination. With little room for cash-out borrowing, the payment change is a scheduled cash-flow shock, not a refinancing choice. I exploit this quasi-experiment to identify borrowers' responses during the 2022–23 rate hikes, using a credit bureau panel of Korean borrowers. The MPC out of the reset-induced increase in interest payments is small, about 0.1, well below what was found in reset studies that exploit rate cuts. Rather than cutting consumption, borrowers respond mainly on the debt margin, by refinancing or paying down their mortgages. This small average response masks an uneven incidence: borrowers who were liquidity constrained before the reset are much less able to refinance or extend maturity, and they instead lose access to unsecured credit and cut card spending by about 3 percent relative to unconstrained borrowers. The burden of monetary tightening thus falls on borrowers who lack access to debt adjustment, suggesting that targeted access to refinancing and maturity extension can mitigate its distributional costs.

2. **Local Projections Meet Big Data: Forecasting Nonlinear Economic Dynamics** (with James Cloyne, Òscar Jordà). 2026.

   We ask whether local projections can forecast nonlinear dynamics, such as crises, without overfitting. We select nonlinear interaction terms sparsely with LASSO and re-estimate the selected model. In out-of-sample forecasts of U.S. industrial production growth, the method is competitive with linear, Bayesian, factor, and penalized-regression benchmarks, and its downturn signals are the most precise at the one-month horizon.

3. **Who Refinances, Who Spends? Refinancing Responsiveness and MPCs** (with Yungu Cho and Heejin Yoon). 2026.

   The consumption effect of a rate cut depends on whether households that refinance quickly are the ones that spend the cash flow they gain. We plan to link the University of California Consumer Credit Panel to GSE loan performance data and HMDA, measure each borrower's revealed refinancing responsiveness and spending response, and enter their covariance into a sufficient statistic that extends the redistribution channel of Auclert (2019) to refinancing.

4. **Mortgage Debt and the Consumption Response to Monetary Policy and Housing Wealth.** 2024.

   This project exploits cross-regional heterogeneity in mortgage-ownership ratios to study how mortgage debt shapes consumption responses to monetary policy and housing wealth. Regions with higher mortgage exposure respond more strongly to interest rate cuts but less to housing wealth gains, consistent with liquidity constraints among wealthy hand-to-mouth households.